LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer | Data Platform
lenavh.dev

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Data Engineer with 9 years of experience designing, building, and operating production data platforms for logistics, payments, and retail. Experienced with large-scale batch and streaming pipelines, cloud data warehouses, dimensional modelling, and query optimisation. Focused on reusable, well-tested data systems, clear data contracts, and trusted analytics.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, Bash
Data platforms and engineering: Airflow, dbt, PySpark, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL, Great Expectations
Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM, MSK), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions, CI/CD
Data engineering practices: Data modelling, dimensional modelling, data quality, data contracts, CDC, orchestration, streaming, batch processing
BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. *March 2022 - Present*

- Own ingestion and orchestration for the data platform, maintaining about 140 Airflow DAGs loading from PostgreSQL, MySQL, Salesforce, and third-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated more than 300 stored procedures to over 420 dbt models with tests and documentation; introduced incremental models and slim CI, reducing nightly warehouse build time from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 50 minutes.
- Designed and built a Kafka-based shipment event pipeline using Kafka Connect and Snowpipe Streaming, processing about 30 million events per day with end-to-end latency under 2 minutes at p95.
- Added a dead-letter topic and replay tooling to the streaming pipeline so failed events can be reprocessed without data loss.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from the orders database with Debezium CDC into Kafka, reducing replica CPU during loads from about 70% to 25%.
- Introduced JSON Schema data contracts and CI checks between product and data teams, reducing broken-pipeline incidents from about 9 per month to about 2 per month.
- Optimised Snowflake warehouse sizing, auto-suspend, and unused-table usage, reducing monthly Snowflake spend from about 38k to 24k in 2024.
- Participate in the data platform on-call rotation, one week in six; mentor two mid-level data engineers and run weekly platform office hours.

Data Engineer | Kovalent Pay *September 2019 - February 2022*

- Built PySpark reconciliation jobs on AWS EMR, processing about 1.2 TB of raw S3 files daily to match bank settlement files against internal ledgers.
- Reduced finance team's manual reconciliation work from about 3 days to about 4 hours per month-end.
- Designed a Redshift star-schema warehouse with more than 30 fact and dimension tables for finance and risk teams.
- Set up Great Expectations data quality checks on critical finance tables.
- Built an internal Python library for S3 and Glue Data Catalog access, used by four teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer | Adria Retail Group *June 2017 - August 2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-premises SQL Server warehouse.
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.
- Built Power BI reports for store operations across more than 40 stores.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science, Data Science track | Northgate Technical University | 2017
Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATION

AWS Certified Data Engineer - Associate | May 2024

COMMUNITY AND OPEN-SOURCE

- Contributed two merged pull requests fixing a pagination bug and adding tests to an open-source Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API.
- Presented “Data contracts without the hype” at a regional data meetup in 2024.
- Teach SQL for beginners at a local women-in-tech meetup, about four evenings per year since 2021.

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)